

Presley Chikopa

Data Analyst || Software Dev || ML Engineer

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Profile

Detail-oriented Data Science student with strong analytical and problem-solving skills, experienced in Python programming, Excel-based financial modeling, and web-based system development. Actively involved in building and supporting digital marketplace and financial management platforms, contributing to system design, process improvement, and data-driven decision-making. Demonstrates strong business awareness, strategic thinking, and the ability to translate real-world problems into scalable technology solutions.

Professional Experience

Associate Developer, Data Analyst, ML Engineer, Tigule Marketplace - Supported growth of the Tigule Marketplace by onboarding sellers and assisting with product listings - Helped optimize marketplace operations to improve user experience and engagement - Assisted in planning and executing growth strategies to increase traffic - Contributed to marketplace development by supporting feature testing and updates - Worked closely with the development team to identify bugs and suggest improvements - Provided technical and operational support	11/2025 – Present Blantyre(Remote)
Technology & Data Lead, Youth for Change Network - Lead the development and implementation of YCN’s digital infrastructure and systems. - Manage and maintain organisational data systems, ensuring data accuracy, security, and accessibility. - Collect, manage, and analyse data to generate insights and support evidence-based decision-making. - Develop digital solutions and improve workflows to enhance organisational efficiency and productivity. - Provide technical leadership and support in technology, data management, and digital transformation initiatives.	08/2026 – Present Lilongwe(Remote)
ML Engineer & Web developer, Sure-Defense Systems MW - Develop and deploy machine learning models to solve business problems and automate processes. - Build, maintain, and improve web applications and internal company platforms. - Work with data to identify insights, patterns, and opportunities for optimization. - Integrate AI/ML solutions into existing products and business workflows. - Develop APIs and backend services to support web and machine learning applications. - Collaborate with other teams to understand business requirements and turn them into technical solutions. - Monitor, test, and improve the performance, reliability, and scalability of applications and ML systems.	06/2026 – Present

Front-End Web Developer, Angels Bracelets

08/2025 – 09/2025

Blantyre

- Developed and implemented the front-end website for Angels Bracelets using React.js and TypeScript
- Integrated Bootstrap for responsive design, ensuring a seamless user experience across devices.
- Built reusable UI components to improve development efficiency and maintainability.
- Collaborated with team members to align design and functionality with business goals

Data Entry & Cleaning, Freelance

04/2025 – 05/2025

Blantyre

- Entered and maintained accurate sales data in Excel spreadsheets.
- Cleaned and formatted large datasets to improve readability and consistency
- Applied Excel formulas and functions to validate and cross-check data

Education

Bachelor Of Science In Data Science (ongoing), Mzuzu University

11/2024 – Present

Mzuzu, Malawi

- Member of Data Science Community
- Obtained an average score of 85% in Python programming assessments, demonstrating strong proficiency in coding and problem-solving

CCNA Computer Networks, Cisco Networking Academy

10/2025 – 12/2025

Mzuzu

Skills

Python

Skilled in Python programming, PyTorch, machine learning engineering, deep learning, NLP, Speech-to-Text, model deployment.

React.js, Next.js, Vue.js, Flutter

Developing dynamic, component-based front-end applications and websites

AI Orchestration

- Coordinating multiple AI tools and systems to work together efficiently
- Designing automated workflows powered by AI
- Integrating AI into business processes for productivity and scale
- Managing data flow between AI models and applications
- Strategically deploying AI solutions to solve real-world problems

Supabase

- Designing and managing PostgreSQL databases, authentication systems, and secure APIs
- Building scalable backend infrastructures with real-time data and cloud storage integration
- Integrating Supabase with web and mobile applications for full-stack development

SQL, SQLite, PostgreSQL

HTML, CSS, JavaScript & Typescript

Building responsive and structured web pages.

Effective Communication

- Clear and concise verbal communication in team and client interactions.
- Presentation and public speaking skills for sharing ideas confidently.

Prompt Engineering

- Crafting precise instructions to generate accurate AI outputs
- Structuring queries to optimize response quality and relevance
- Refining prompts through iteration and testing
- Controlling tone, format, and depth of AI-generated content
- Reducing ambiguity to improve AI performance

Microsoft Power BI

- Designing interactive dashboards and data visualizations for business insights
- Transforming and modeling data using Power Query and DAX
- Connecting multiple data sources to build automated reporting systems

Certificates

Malawi School Certificate of Education (James Chiona Catholic High School)

Achieved 15 points at secondary school level

CCNA: Digital Safety and Security Awareness

CCNA: Introduction to Data Science

Data Cleaning (Kaggle)

- Gained hands-on experience in cleaning and preparing datasets for analysis
- Learned techniques for handling missing values, correcting data types, and removing duplicates
- Applied Python libraries such as Pandas and NumPy to perform efficient data cleaning tasks

Pandas (Kaggle)

- Built proficiency in using Pandas for data manipulation and analysis.
- Learned to filter, sort, group, and aggregate datasets effectively.

CCNA: Introduction to Computer Networks

- Basics of computer networking
- Network devices and topologies
- OSI and TCP/IP models
- IP addressing fundamentals
- Basic routing, switching, and security concepts

Python (Kaggle)

- Developed strong skills in Python programming, including variables, functions, loops, and object-oriented concepts.
- Gained experience working with data structures such as lists, dictionaries, and sets.

Languages

- English
- Chichewa

Projects

ALONDA Real-Time Cheating Detection System,

Data Acquisition and preprocessing

- Acquired and curated examination video datasets for model training and evaluation. Cleaned, labeled, and preprocessed data to improve model performance.
- Prepared structured datasets for computer vision and machine learning pipelines.
- Assisted in feature extraction and data quality assurance processes.
- Supported the development of a real-time student behavior analysis system for cheating detection.

PSC (Pay Smart Consumption) System,

Lead Developer & Machine Learning Engineer

- Lead the design and development of a real-time utility management platform for monitoring and purchasing household utility units.
- Architect and implement front-end and back-end system components to ensure scalability, performance, and reliability.
- Develop machine learning models that forecast future utility consumption using historical usage patterns.
- Build data processing pipelines for collecting, cleaning, and analyzing consumption data in real time.
- Collaborate with stakeholders to translate business requirements into data-driven features that support smarter resource planning and cost management

Madrid Weather Dataset EDA

Cleaned and performed Exploratory Data Analysis (EDA) on the Madrid Weather Dataset using Python and its libraries.

07/2025 – 07/2025

Tigule STT (Speech-to-Text) Model Build & Context Biasing

- Developed Tigule STT, a specialized Speech-to-Text system based on OpenAI's Whisper architecture.
- Enabled transcription of English, Chichewa, and code-switched marketplace terminology.
- Implemented vocabulary biasing using Whisper's initial_prompt to improve recognition of local and e-commerce terms.
- Built text normalization to standardize transcriptions for backend processing.
- Packaged the model and configurations into a portable .pkl deployment file for CPU/GPU integration.
- Established STT performance evaluation using Word Error Rate (WER), Character Error Rate (CER), and Real-Time Speed Factor.
- Created the foundation for future fine-tuning on Chichewa and marketplace-specific audio datasets.
- Enabled potential voice search, voice-based product listing, and voice commands for Tigule's e-commerce platform.